



Buns not guns

3D printed gun files are being kept a close eye on by some countries. Read more about the controversy here <http://digit.in/prntdguns>



Literally CHIMP

DARPA'S robot 'C.H.I.M.P.' turns out to be dumber than it looks. Read more: <http://digit.in/drparbt>

Smartbands



WEAR IT RIGHT

Smart wearable wristbands are exploding in the market all around us. We compare some of the top contenders vying for your wrist.

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You there. Yes you! The one who doesn't go outside and play and prefers to give voice commands to his phone rather than actually press the buttons. Traditionally we geeks are known to be a lazy lot, after all, why spend years of stored energy for something that a simple gesture can accomplish right? No, don't make a face now, you know you're one of us.

We're here to tell you that your way of life is being threat-

ened by what you love the most — tech. If there was ever a chance that we would go out an exercise, it is now, because of what tech companies are calling wearable technology. Yes, smartbands, fitness bands, smartwatches, GPS powered watches and more. While a lazy lot we might be, we also drool over the newest technology, and guess what, you can't really use a fitness band without working towards being fit. #Groan.

What's more, there's actually a market beyond us here. There are tech savvy fitness enthusiasts who see these gadgets pro-

viding good value. It does make sense in some ways, why spend 10k per year on the cheapest gym when you can buy a fitness band for 4k and do it yourself? They're not exactly perfect yet, but they're getting there very very quickly.

With companies like Samsung and Motorola focusing on smartwatches and so many more trying to capitalise on the health and fitness craze, this has become the most opportune time for a comparison like this. The market is just about to pick up, and things in this area are still at the initial stages. It's

like when smartphones were just starting out, you knew they were really cool, but you weren't sure if spending your money on them was worth it. While this trend may not pick up as easily, wearables will make sense in the future, the very near future.

THE COMPETITORS

Five smartbands were compared, with their prices ranging from ₹999 to ₹13,000. Namely, these are the Xiaomi Mi Band, Goqii Band, Timex IRONMAN Move X20, Fitgen Trek and the Huawei Talkband B2.